

CHURCH See panel, below.

CHURRIGUERESQUE A style of elaborate sculptural ornament typically applied to the facades of buildings. It was popular in the 17th–18th centuries and derives its name from the Spanish architect and sculptor José Benito Churriguera (1665–1725). Its extravagant, florid detailing is most commonly found in Spain and Mexico.

CINDER BLOCK A large brick made from cement and ashes. Cinder blocks are called breeze blocks in the UK.

CLAPBOARD A style of construction using long, thin boards of timber laid horizontally and overlapping to clad exterior walls.

CLASSICAL Relating to the architecture of ancient Greece and Rome, characterized by its column-and-pediment structures, fixed proportions, symmetry, and decorative orders (notably Doric, Ionic, and Corinthian). *See also* order.

CLASSICISM The revival of the forms and techniques associated with Classical architecture. *See* *Neo-Classical*.

CLERESTORY The high section of a church where the walls rise above the aisle roofs and are set with windows to admit light into the interior. *See also* aisle, church.

CLOISTER A covered walkway around a quadrangle. It is usually attached to a cathedral, monastery, or college.

COB A natural building material made from soil, clay, and straw.

COFFER A square, rectangular, or octagonal sunken panel used in a grid to decorate a ceiling. The most famous example of a coffered ceiling is the interior of the dome of the Pantheon in Rome, where the coffers are used to lighten the weight of the structure.

COLONIAL REVIVAL A design movement in the US and Canada that gained popularity in the 1890s. Inspired by the Georgian architecture

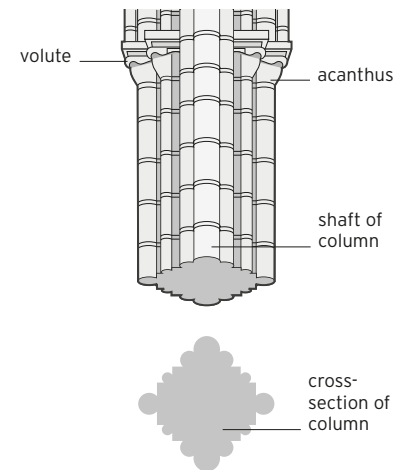
of England, buildings are typically two stories and strongly symmetrical, and the detailing is influenced by Classical architecture. Main entrances are usually pronounced, with a large door framed by a portico. *See also* Classical, portico.

COLONNADE A row of columns, often carrying an entablature. *See also* entablature.

COLOSSAL ORDER An order of Classical architecture in which columns extend the height of two or more stories in a building. It is also sometimes called the giant order. *See also* composite order, order.

COLUMN A cylindrical shaft with a base and a capital. Columns usually support a structure, but they can also be free-standing monuments—for example, Trajan's Column in Rome. *See also* capital, order.

COMPOSITE ORDER An order of Classical architecture that combines the volutes found in the Ionic order with acanthus leaves from the Corinthian order. *See also* Classical, Colossal order, Corinthian, Ionic, order.



COMPOUND COLUMN ▲ A column made up of a number of slender columns grouped together; this is done for decorative effect. Many compound columns use stones of different types.

COMPUTER-AIDED DESIGN (CAD) The use of computer software packages by architects to aid in the design of buildings and other structures. First introduced in the 1960s, CAD became widespread from the 1990s onward.

CONCRETE A composite material made from cement, water, and an aggregate such as sand or gravel. Relatively cheap, strong, durable, and resistant to fire, water, and decay, concrete can also be molded into almost any shape.

CONFESSIO A niche for relics located near the altar in a church. *See also* altar, church.

CONTEMPORARY Relating to 21st-century architecture. No single style predominates, but what many structures have in common is the use of advanced technology to push the boundaries of what a building can be. Buildings are reaching higher than ever and assuming unconventional nonrectilinear, asymmetrical shapes.

CORBEL A type of bracket that projects from a wall to support an arch, beam, or balcony. Corbels tend

CHURCH

During the first four centuries of Christianity, worshippers met in private houses. In time, dedicated houses of worship, called churches, developed. A typical early church would be entered from the west, with a nave leading to the chancel, which is an elevated area used by officials, or clergy, who lead the worship. Central to

the chancel is the altar, the table used for the Christian rite of Communion. Larger churches may have additional aisles, or transepts, or an ambulatory around the altar. However, there are no set requirements for what constitutes a church. It is simply a meeting place for shared religious observance.

